

Culture in the Team, Not the Country



Use this planner to design a respectful, curiosity-based question to learn how your team works.



1. Pick the Focus Area: What team habit or expectation are you curious about?

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How feedback is shared

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How meetings run

☐

What “urgent” or “ASAP” means

☐

How decisions are made

☐

Who speaks up and when

☐

Something else:_____

2. What Do You Want to Learn? Try using a who/what/when prompt:

Who usually leads or responds in this situation?

What does a “good” version of this task look like?

When do people usually follow up, give input, or expect answers?

Write your goal:

I want to understand -----

3. Choose Your Tone: Match your question to your team style.

Style	Example Question
Neutral	“How do we usually share feedback here?”
Formal	“Could you clarify our usual approach to feedback?”
Casual	“Hey, how do we usually give feedback around here?”

Check one:

☐ Neutral ☐ Formal ☐ Casual

Now write your version:

4. Add a Softener or Context (optional): Soften direct questions to sound more open.

Try phrases like:

"Just checking..."

"I've seen it done a few ways, how do we usually...?"

"In other teams I've worked with..."

"I'm still getting a feel for things, can I ask...?"

Write your intro/context:

5. Final Check: Use this mini checklist before you ask:

- Is it **open-ended**, not yes/no?
- Does it sound **curious**, not critical?
- Would **you** feel okay being asked this?

